

NEW ENGLAND CRUST

Pizza Party Planning Kit

The hosting timeline. The dough math. The topping bar list.
Everything you need to run pizza night for a crowd — without losing your mind.

PAGE 1 Timeline

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PAGE ONE

The Pizza Night Hosting Timeline

The secret to a relaxed pizza night is doing nothing on the day except cooking. Everything else happens in the 48 hours before your guests arrive.

48 HOURS BEFORE

- Make your dough and put it in the fridge to cold ferment
- Count your guest total and check dough quantity table (page 2)
- Write your shopping list using the topping bar guide (page 3)
- Confirm you have enough pellets (refill if under half a bag)
- Check your extension cord and cover are in place

24 HOURS BEFORE

- Shop for toppings, drinks, and any missing ingredients
- Buy extra flour and semolina for dusting the peel
- Prep any proteins that need marinating (chicken, sausage)
- Set up your serving area — boards, pizza wheel, napkins
- Charge any Bluetooth speakers for outdoor ambiance

MORNING OF

- Pull dough from fridge — leave sealed, let it begin to warm
- Prep all toppings: slice, drain, and portion into small bowls
- Set up the topping bar station before guests arrive
- Pre-slice fresh mozzarella and blot dry with paper towels
- Chill drinks and set up the beverage station

1 HOUR BEFORE GUESTS ARRIVE

- Ball your dough portions (one per pizza) — cover loosely
- Set out topping bar so it's ready when guests walk in
- Preheat the Ninja Woodfire — Pizza mode, max temp
- Check stone temp with infrared thermometer (target: 650–750°F)
- Have your peel, brush, and infrared thermometer within reach

GUESTS ARRIVE — YOU'RE COOKING

- Rotate each pizza at 45 seconds — every cook, without exception
- Let guests build their own — give them 2 minutes at the bar
- Cook one pizza at a time, serve immediately — don't stack
- Refill pellet hopper every 45–60 minutes if smoking
- Save yourself the last pizza — you earned it

AFTER — THE RIGHT CALL

- Leave the stone to cool fully before covering
- Wipe interior with damp cloth once cool — nothing else needed
- Store leftover dough balls in fridge up to 2 more days
- Clean up tomorrow morning — not tonight

HOST TIP

The 1-hour-before window is the most important. If your stone isn't at temperature when guests arrive, the first pizza will disappoint. Preheat early and check with the infrared thermometer — not the display.

PAGE TWO

Dough Quantity Calculator

Each row is one pizza night. Scale up or down based on your guest count. These quantities work with any standard pizza dough recipe — adjust hydration to match your preferred dough style.

GUESTS	PIZZAS (10–12")	FLOUR (grams)	WATER (ml)	SALT (grams)	YEAST (grams)	OIL (tbsp)
4	4	1,000	630	25	3	3
6	6	1,500	945	38	5	4
8	8	2,000	1260	50	6	6
10	10	2,500	1575	63	8	7
12	12	3,000	1890	75	9	8
16	16	4,000	2520	100	12	11
20	20	5,000	3150	125	15	14

One pizza per person

for a full meal. Add 2 extra if you have big eaters or want leftovers.

Make dough the night before

Cold ferment (12–72 hrs in the fridge) gives better flavor and easier stretching.

Ball your dough 1 hour before cooking

Cover loosely with a damp cloth and let rest at room temp.

Flour type matters

00 flour = softer, more extensible dough. Bread flour = chewier, more structured crust.

Scale by weight, not volume

A kitchen scale makes consistent dough. Cups of flour vary too much.

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Topping Bar Shopping List

Set these out in small bowls before guests arrive. You don't need everything — pick one or two from each category and let people build their own. The topping bar is the party.

SAUCES & BASES

- ☐ Classic tomato sauce
San Marzano if you can find them
- ☐ White sauce / béchamel
Good base for mushroom or potato pizzas
- ☐ Pesto
Basil or sun-dried tomato
- ☐ Olive oil + garlic
Simple and underrated
- ☐ Hot honey
Drizzle after baking — not a base

PROTEINS

- ☐ Pepperoni
Classic — get the cupping kind if possible
- ☐ Italian sausage
Remove from casing, cook before topping
- ☐ Prosciutto or speck
Add after baking — heat kills the texture
- ☐ Anchovies
Optional — but worth having for one pizza
- ☐ Grilled chicken
Pre-cook and slice thin
- ☐ Smoked salmon
Post-bake only, with crème fraîche

FINISHERS & EXTRAS

- ☐ Hot honey
Mike's Hot Honey or any good brand
- ☐ Fresh basil
Add after baking — it wilts instantly in the oven
- ☐ Chili flakes
Set out in a small bowl at the table
- ☐ Flaky sea salt
Maldon on top after baking
- ☐ Extra virgin olive oil
Drizzle just before serving
- ☐ Lemon
A squeeze brightens almost any white pizza

CHEESES

- ☐ Fresh mozzarella
Slice and blot dry before using
- ☐ Low-moisture mozzarella
Better melt, less water release
- ☐ Burrata
Add after baking — not before
- ☐ Parmesan or Pecorino
Finish grating at the table
- ☐ Gorgonzola or blue cheese
Small amounts go a long way
- ☐ Ricotta
Dollop on before or after baking

VEGETABLES

- ☐ Roasted red peppers
Jarred is fine — drain and slice
- ☐ Caramelized onions
Make ahead — they take 45 minutes
- ☐ Mushrooms
Sauté first or they'll steam on the stone
- ☐ Fresh arugula
Add after baking with lemon and oil
- ☐ Sun-dried tomatoes
Oil-packed, roughly chopped
- ☐ Artichoke hearts
Jarred, drained and quartered
- ☐ Olives
Kalamata or Castelvetrano, pitted
- ☐ Jalapeños
Fresh or pickled — both work

DON'T FORGET

- ☐ Semolina or flour for dusting the peel
- ☐ Extra paper towels for blotting mozzarella
- ☐ Parchment squares for staging built pizzas
- ☐ A sharpie to label topping bowls for guests
- ☐ Small tongs for each topping bowl
- ☐ A pizza wheel — not a knife

Print this page and bring it to the store. You don't need everything on the list — two sauces, three cheeses, two proteins, and a handful of vegetables is more than enough for any group. The topping bar does the entertaining for you.